



The keyboard will definitely take a while to get used to—keys are shuffled around, and some just don't exist. For starters, the [Windows] key isn't where it's supposed to be—between the [Ctrl] and [Alt] key—it's placed at the bottom-centre of the keyboard! This is surprising; it's rather silly of Microsoft to break away from the traditional layout of their own Windows key—and it really does make it hard to use shortcuts that involve that key.

The mouse goes well with the keyboard, and matches the colour scheme. It looks like a stealth aircraft because of its not-so-smooth edges and flat look. During regular use, there's no delay, but a very slight delay is noticeable when gaming.

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Logitech G15

Logitech has some really nice products for gamers, and the G15 should fit the bill quite well. The G15 adds on a lot of keys, especially ones used for gaming. There are six three-key rows on the left that can be used for a whole lot of games. Apart from the 18 keys, you can also store up to three profiles—effectively, that's 54 shortcut keys that can be used in various games.

All the keys on the G15 are backlit, and though most gamers don't look at their keyboards when gaming, it does look pretty. A key on the G15 can toggle the brightness levels of the LCD screen and the backlight. The keys feel good—they have good feedback and are comfortable for long hours of gaming.

What makes the G15 really stand apart from other gaming keyboards is the foldable LCD screen. Under the screen are controls for the media player. The buttons for these aren't the best though: they are clunky. With the drivers installed, the LCD shows information like CPU and RAM utilisation, and song information from your media player. That's not all—there are communities and forums online that have developed neat little mods for the screen of the G15. An online search reveals useful mods such as bandwidth

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Razer Tarantula

With Logitech pumping out products one after the other, Razer obviously isn't going to take it lying down. The Razer Tarantula is its reply to the G15. It doesn't have an LCD screen, so why should you pay more for this? Let's find out...

When it comes to looks, the Tarantula has things going its way. The entire keyboard has a piano-black glossy finish—apart from the matte hand-rest—even the back of keyboard

The mouse runs off a single AA battery, and feels heavy. The keyboard requires 4 AA batteries, which are housed in two bays, and you can break a nail when trying to unlock them—thankfully, you won't be doing this often. The mouse comes with a charging dock, so no such drama here. Because of the Bluetooth connectivity, there are no range issues at normal distances.

If you get this keyboard, it's going to be a bit tedious to use in the beginning, and you should be prepared to look down all the time to find the keys that have been moved about.

You're going to have to decide whether it's worth all that trouble, especially at a price tag of Rs 8,523. But it's pretty good value for its price, and the touchpad can be a handy tool for a Media Center PC.



monitors, e-mail notifications, chat notifications, and—as you might expect—even silly ones, like for virtual pets.

The keyboard software can also detect games on your hard drives and tell you a whole set of custom functions that you can set. For example, the whole list of tasks and heroes in *Warcraft 3* was displayed, and could be assigned to keys.

With all the extra keys and the LCD, you'd think this keyboard was really bulky, but it's not! The keys are a little thinner than those on standard keyboards, so people with thicker-than-normal fingers—and touch typists—might have a little trouble.

We have no serious complaints about the G15, and at Rs 4,995, its pretty good value for money compared to the Razer Tarantula. Gamers should definitely consider getting one for any genre of game.

has the same treatment, though no one's ever going to see it.

Like the G15, the Tarantula, too, has backlit keys, except for the custom keys on the left and right of the keyboard. What special here is the fact that you can replace the keys with a custom set that comes bundled. The keys are made to be removable.

When it comes to the number of custom keys, the Tarantula doesn't come close to the

G15. Also, despite the fewer keys, the Tarantula is still pretty huge. It has expansion ports like the G15, but adds on a microphone and headphone jack. There's also a female mini USB plug hidden away under a small panel at the top of the keyboard.

The feel of the keys on the Tarantula is unique—there's a tiny bit of initial resistance when you press down on them before they sink in. The keyboard feels like a cross between the soft, mushy, ergonomic keyboards of today and the mechanical keyboards of the '90s. There's little or no confusion in key layout, and it's good fun playing and typing on it.

The Tarantula might look great and feel even better, but it lacks the LCD and the large number of gamer keys that the G15 gives you—and yet ends up being the costlier option. Rs 6,750 is a fairly larger sum of money, for what we can only think is the glowing Razer logo at the top.



RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Logitech MX518

Some of you might be surprised to see us reviewing the considerably older Logitech MX518. While everybody's busy racing to win the dpi mark, the MX518 has stayed at 1600 dpi—but then, you've got to think, do we really need higher dpi values?

Because of its camouflage and dented-metal-look, the MX518 is a pretty devil. It's got a clean glossy top surface with a matte finish on the sides. The MX518 stands higher than the Razer mice, for example, so people with larger hands are bound to find it more comfortable—it's not heavier, though.

The mouse tracks well on almost any surface, except those that are very glossy—but this holds true for any optical mouse. The mouse has the standard left- and right-click buttons that are concealed well with the body. Apart from this, it also has two buttons for moving backward and forward through Web pages, two for changing dpi settings on the fly, and one to quick-switch between applications. All of these can be customised using the drivers, but they're so bulky that most people uninstall them rather quickly!

Available almost everywhere in the Indian market for around Rs 1,550, the MX518 is great value for money. If your mouse just died on you or if you want to get a substantial upgrade minus a large hole in your pocket, this is quite undoubtedly the mouse for you.



RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



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